

Lenny Kidavi

I design and build products end to end, and I'm working toward machine learning engineering.

Lang'ata, Nairobi, Kenya

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Summary

Computer Science student and developer in Nairobi. I design and build web products end to end, and I am working toward machine learning engineering.

Experience

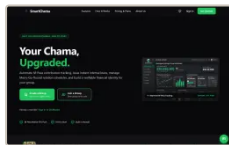
Independent software developer Self-employed · Nairobi, Kenya 2025 – present

- Built SmartChama with a team of four: digital savings and loan management for chamas, with a Solidity/Ethereum smart-contract layer. Winner of Red, White & Build 2026.
- Main founder of Saka, a team of five building a market place for finding verified local tradespeople in Nairobi.
- Built client websites for Oppolia Woodworks Kenya and Sucre Bushworks.

Education

Catholic University of Eastern Africa (CUEA) 2025–2028 (expected)
BSc Computer Science · Lang'ata, Nairobi, Kenya

Projects

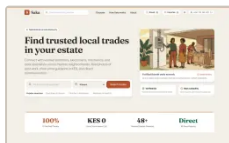


SmartChama Product · 2026

www.smartchama.tech

Digital platform for Kenyan chama savings groups, automating M-Pesa contribution tracking, internal loans, Merry-Go-Round rotation schedules, and smart-contract verification.

Stack: Next.js, TypeScript, Tailwind CSS, Solidity, Ethereum



Saka Product · 2025

sakahapa.vercel.app

Inquiry-first market place connecting Nairobi households with verified local plumbers, electricians, and mechanics, with zero commission and direct M-Pesa payments.

Role: Lead Founder & Full-Stack Developer

Stack: Next.js 14, Supabase, Cloudinary, Google Maps, Zustand, TanStack Query, next-pwa, Upstash Redis, Vercel



Oppolia Woodworks Kenya Client work

www.oppoliakenya.co.ke

High-end brand and showcase website for Oppolia Woodworks Kenya, displaying custom luxury cabinetry, wardrobes, and architectural interior fittings.

Stack: Next.js, Tailwind CSS, TypeScript

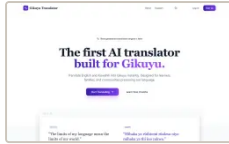


Sucre Bushworks Client work

sucre-bushworks.vercel.app

Camping gear, Kenyan campsites and guided trips, with a WhatsApp inquiry basket.

Stack: Next.js, Tailwind CSS, TypeScript



Gikuyu Translator Experiment

gikuyu-translate.vercel.app

AI translation from English and Kiswahili into Gikuyu, designed for learners, families and communities preserving the language.

Stack: Next.js, TypeScript, Tailwind CSS

Hackathons

Winner · Red, White & Build US–Kenya Hackathon (AI & Tech)

19 February 2026 · Nairobi, Kenya

First place with Smart Chama at the U.S. Embassy Kenya AI & Tech hackathon.

Organised by: U.S. Embassy Kenya · Prize: \$1,000 · Team: Lenny Kidavi, Rachael, Shilla, Nanjoli

Second place · Beorchild Hackathon

2026 · Online

Second place finish with Smart Chama at the online Beorchild hackathon.

Organised by: Beorchild · Team: Lenny Kidavi, Rachael, Shilla

Skills

Shipped with: TypeScript, JavaScript, Next.js (App Router), React, Tailwind CSS, Node.js, Supabase, PostgreSQL, Solidity, Vercel, Zustand, TanStack Query

Used in coursework and experiments: Python, Java, C, C++, FastAPI, Web3, Git & GitHub, Docker, REST APIs

Currently learning: PyTorch, Machine Learning Systems, Applied Mathematics for ML, Model Optimization

Links

Portfolio: lennydev.vercel.app GitHub: github.com/chillyreward

LinkedIn: www.linkedin.com/in/lenny-kidavi-4693ba355 Fiverr: www.fiverr.com/lennynavwani